Juan C. Yamin

Department of Economics, Brown University
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Fields: Econometrics, Development
Research interests: Statistical decision theory, experimental design, causal inference

Academic Appointments

University of Oxford and Nuffield College Sept. 2027–Aug. 2030
Postdoctoral Research Fellow (incoming)

Education

Brown University, Providence, RI
Ph.D. in Economics May 2027
Dissertation committee: Toru Kitagawa, Soonwoo Kwon, Jonathan Roth
M.A. in Economics May 2022

Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá, Colombia
M.Sc. in Economics March 2019
B.Sc. in Economics October 2017

Publications

Birds of a Feather Collude Together: Subnational Alignment and Corruption
with Leopoldo Fergusson, Arturo Harker, and Carlos Molina
Forthcoming in the American Political Science Review

Working Papers

Poverty Targeting with Imperfect Information
Best Student Paper Award, Midwest Econometrics Group, 2026

When and How to Pilot: Design Rules for Two-Wave Experiments

Two-Way Effects Models: A Nonparametric Empirical Bayes Approach
with Cole Davis *Draft available upon request*

Software

cmrdesign (R and Python) Documentation | Code | CRAN | PyPI
Uses pilot data to choose main-wave treatment and control sample shares and report a finite-sample regret certificate. Supports two-arm, multi-arm, and stratified experiments.

Awards and Fellowships

Best Student Paper Award, Midwest Econometrics Group 2026
Merit Dissertation Fellowship, Department of Economics, Brown University Fall 2026
International Travel Fund, Graduate School, Brown University 2025
Conference Travel Fund, Graduate School, Brown University 2025

Research and Industry Experience

Brown University, Department of Economics June 2023–Jan. 2026
Research Assistant to Soonwoo Kwon, Providence, RI
Conducted simulations and empirical applications on fixed-effect shrinkage, regression discontinuity, and bias-aware inference in regularized regression.

Amazon, Delivery Experience May–Aug. 2025
Economist Intern, Bellevue, WA
Evaluated a nationwide delivery-speed program using difference-in-differences and shift-share IV to estimate direct and geographic spillover effects.

Universidad de los Andes, Department of Economics Aug. 2017–July 2021
Research Assistant to Leopoldo Fergusson and James A. Robinson, Bogotá, Colombia
Built datasets and implemented instrumental-variables, regression-discontinuity, and panel-data methods to study conflict, corruption, and state capacity.

Conference Presentations

Conference on Digital Experimentation (CODE@MIT), Cambridge 2026
When and How to Pilot: Design Rules for Two-Wave Experiments
Accepted for presentation

Midwest Econometrics Group Annual Meeting, Cincinnati 2026
Poverty Targeting with Imperfect Information

World Congress of the Econometric Society, Seoul 2025
Poverty Targeting with Imperfect Information

Advances with Field Experiments, Chicago 2025
When and How to Pilot: Design Rules for Two-Wave Experiments

Teaching Experience

Brown University, Teaching Assistant
Applied Econometrics II (Ph.D.), Peter Hull — Spring 2026 and 2027
Applied Econometrics I (Ph.D.), Toru Kitagawa — Fall 2024
Using Big Data to Solve Economic and Social Problems (undergraduate), John N. Friedman — Fall 2022 and 2023

Universidad de los Andes, Teaching Assistant Aug. 2018–June 2020
Advanced Econometrics (graduate), Raquel Bernal
Political Underpinnings of Prosperity and Poverty (graduate), James A. Robinson
Thinking Problems (undergraduate), Tomás Rodríguez

Academic Service

Organizer, Brown Metrics Coffee 2024–26

Technical Skills and Languages

Tools: R, Python, Stata, MATLAB, SQL, Git, LaTeX
Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent), French (fluent)